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Subject-Verb Agreement

- Rules:-

1 use of plural verb with a plural subject & singular verb with a singular subject.

* Raman spends his free time listening to music.
* Raman and Shashi spend thier free time listening to music.

2 Compound subjects combine using the conjuction 'and'. They take a plural verb.

* Mohan, Soham and Ravi have completed their work.
* Kiran and Radha are on their way to the airport.

3 When more than one noun is joined by conjuction 'or', the subject is singular and a singular verb is used.

* Your mother or father has to attend the meeting.

4 Sentences with pronounes such as anybody, anyone, nothing, etc are treated as singular subjects and therefore use a singular verb.

* Nobody has participated in the competition.

5 For sentences using 'either.... or' and 'niether.... nor'. The verb should agree with the noun that comes just before it.

* Niether Ravi nor Shyam is here yet.
* Either Shyam or his family members has to take responsibilities.

6 Abstract nouns and uncountable nouns are considered as singular subject so they use singular verb.

* 'Honesty is the best policy.
* Milk is good for health.

7 When the subject refers to a period of time, distance, sum of money, use a singular verb.

* Five hundred rupees is a big amount.
* Ten thousand kilometers is a long distance to travel.

8 The use of collective noun as a subject: When we have a collective noun, the verb can be singular or plural based on the context.

* My family is settled in Germany.
* All the teams have arrived for the tournament.

9 Adjectives such as 'a lot of', Some, lots of, etc. are used along with the noun to form a phrase that acts as a subject of the sentence. The verb is according to the noun just before it.

* A lot of food is left out.
* Some of the books are damaged.

10 'Each' or 'Every' as the subject consider a singular verb.

* Each student has been asked to provide the homework.
* Every teacher, parent and student is expected to work as a team.

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To express a wish or a sentence expressing a wish, words are used in a different way.
I wish I were a bird.
We request that everyone make their own choices.

when a phrase comes between a subject and a verb, the verb still agrees with subject and not with the noun or pronoun in the phrase following the subject.
The student as well as the committee members is excited.
The focus of the interview was the selection of nine digible candidates.